

US–Iran Conflict Briefing

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Trump Rules Out Iran Strikes Before Midterms

- President Trump said on Truth Social Thursday that the United States 'will not be attacking Iran at any time prior to the Midterm Elections to be held in the United States on November 3rd,' while calling U.S.-Iran talks 'productive' and insisting the naval blockade stays in full force. — [Reuters](#)
- Trump asserted that 22 million barrels of oil flowed through the Strait of Hormuz the prior night with 'not one barrel coming from, or going to, Iran' — a figure analysts dispute; Reuters notes the U.S. government claims prewar-level flows while analysts disagree. — [Reuters](#)
- A recent Reuters/Ipsos poll found 60 percent of Americans, including one in four Republicans, disapprove of Trump's handling of Iran. — [Reuters](#)
- Iran's state media quoted the head of the Atomic Energy Organization of Iran as saying Thursday that Tehran will not abandon uranium enrichment or hand over its uranium stockpile, days after Vice President Vance told Reuters Iran must make 'meaningful' reductions in enrichment capacity. — [Reuters](#)

Houthis Hit Riyadh and Najran in New Wave of Airport Strikes; Airlines Suspend Flights

- The Houthis said Thursday they carried out a new wave of attacks with cruise and ballistic missiles targeting King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh, Najran Airport near the southern border, and the Royal Saudi Air Force's King Khalid Air Base, claiming damage and disrupted air traffic; images verified by CNN showed smoke rising over Terminal 4 at King Khalid airport and a damaged Saudi aircraft. — [CNN](#)
- Saudi authorities said Thursday they intercepted and destroyed two ballistic missiles fired toward Riyadh; debris from an intercepted missile damaged a kindergarten and a medical clinic, with no casualties reported. — [CNN](#)
- The U.S. Mission in Saudi Arabia warned Americans of possible flight cancellations, airspace closures and travel disruptions, and restricted U.S. government employees' use of Riyadh airport. — [CNN](#)
- Lufthansa Group airlines and Air India said Thursday they will suspend flights to Riyadh — Lufthansa through October 16 and Air India through October 10 — amid the renewed Houthi threats against airlines. — [Reuters](#)
- The Saudi-led coalition said late Wednesday it struck 82 Houthi military targets across Saada, Hodeidah, Al-Jawf and Marib in retaliation for the earlier airport attacks, targeting missile depots, command centers, communications facilities and weapons stockpiles. — [CNN](#)

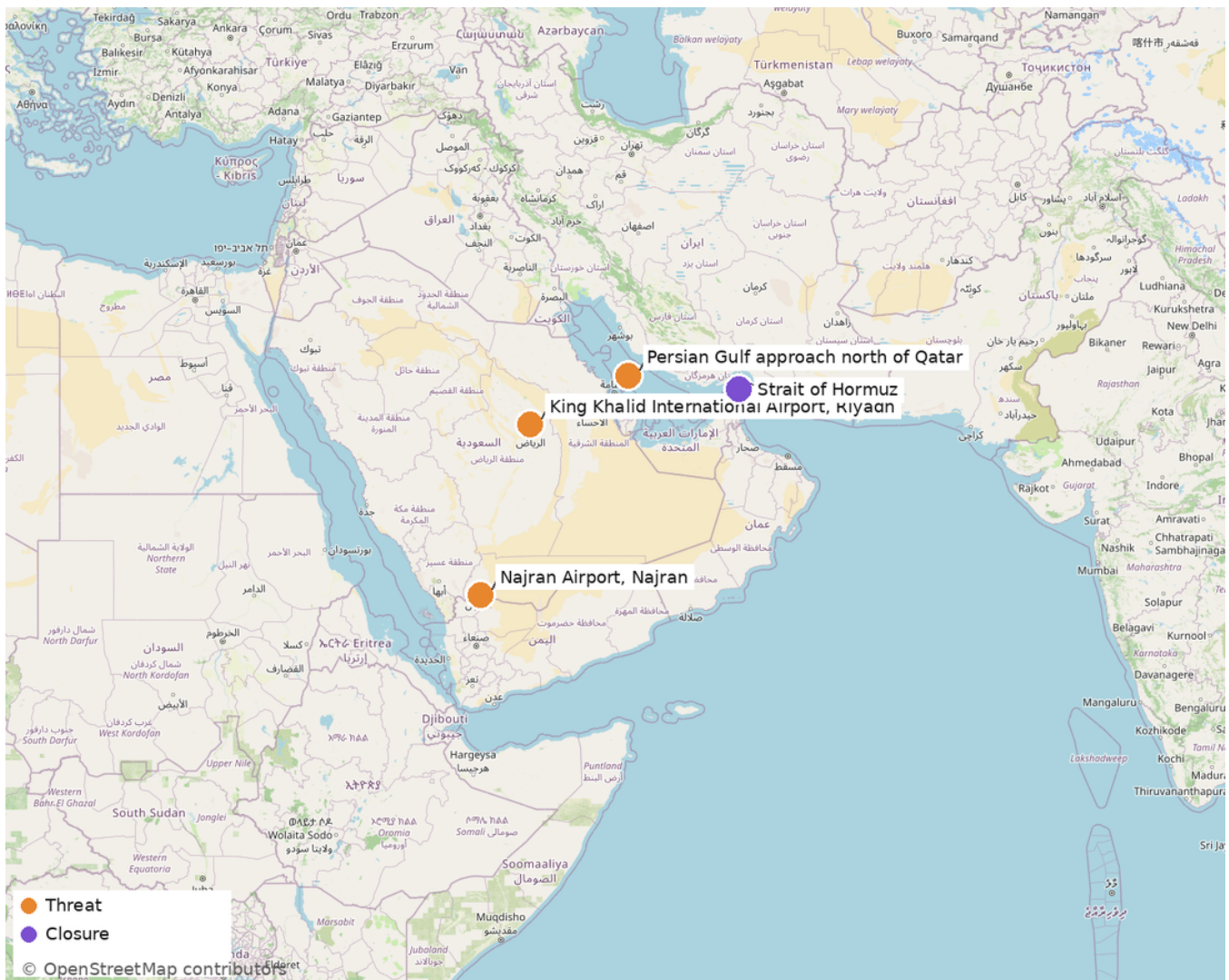
Iran Vows to Block More Hormuz Routes

- Iran warned regional countries Thursday that any attempt to open new oil-export routes would be considered hostile — a plan agreed by Iran's political leaders and the Revolutionary Guards, a senior regional official told Reuters; a regional diplomat briefed by Tehran said it could involve missile and drone attacks on ships or vessels sent to scare ships away, calling it a 'policy of fear and threats.' — [Reuters](#)
- Maritime risk firm Clearwater Dynamics warned the Acers strike raises the prospect of a wider combat area affecting approaches to Qatar, Bahrain, Saudi Arabia, Kuwait and Iraq; BIMCO said the spate of Iranian attacks has dampened shipowners' appetite to sail through the strait. — [Reuters](#)

Markets

- Brent settled at \$103.79 a barrel on October 8 (ICE front-month futures); the Wall Street Journal's October 8 markets coverage reports a roughly four-percent settlement rally on revived Middle East supply worries and Hurricane Isaias shutting in Gulf of Mexico output. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- WTI settled at \$91.18 a barrel on October 8 (NYMEX front-month futures), up about three point six percent on the session, per the Wall Street Journal. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- VLCC day rates on Gulf-to-East Asia routes hit a record near \$1.4 million a day as ship-to-ship transfers outside Hormuz tie up the tanker fleet (Bloomberg, October 8). — [Bloomberg](#)

Conflict map



Markers show reported strike sites, bases, and shipping areas. Purple polygons mark approximate or announced closure / exclusion zones.

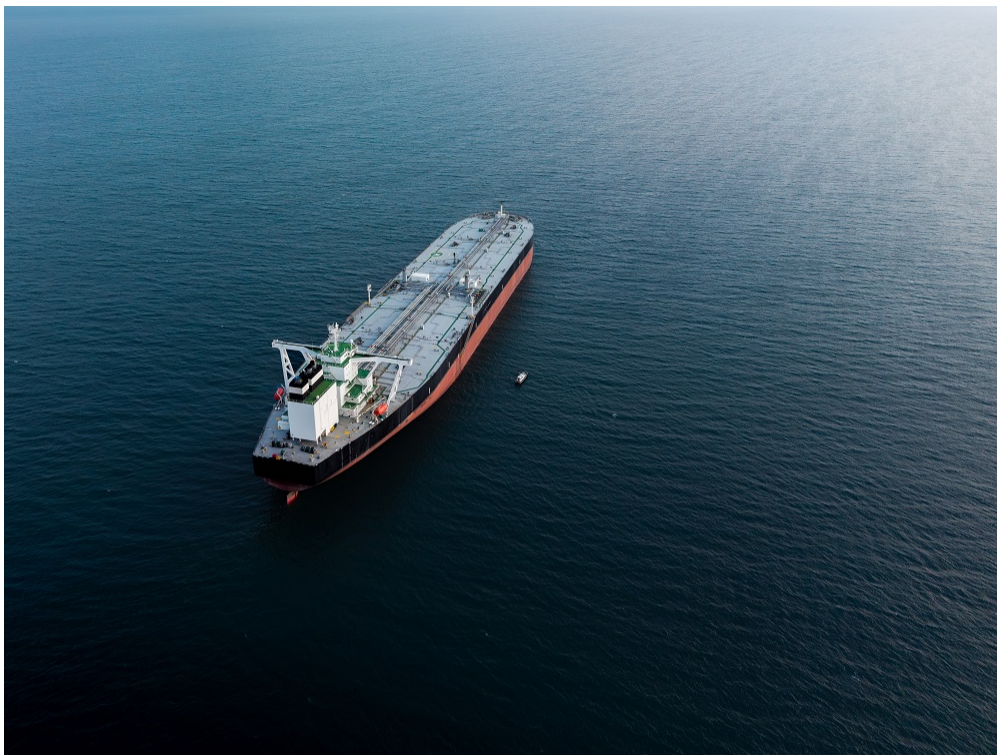
Related media



Tankers transiting the Strait of Hormuz, where Iran is now vowing to block additional oil-export routes. — [view original](#)



King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh, hit by a new wave of Houthi missile attacks Thursday. — [view original](#)



An oil tanker at sea near the Strait of Hormuz, where VLCC day rates hit a record near one point four million dollars a day. — [view original](#)

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